

Saving, not spending

The youth are not as extravagant as they are thought to be

Young people know what their priorities are. Today's young men and women, and not just those who are married, save **19%** of their income. Small town youth save less than big city youth.

Women are more thrifty and save over **20%** of their income, but they also spend more than men on beauty and personal care products (**11.6%**).

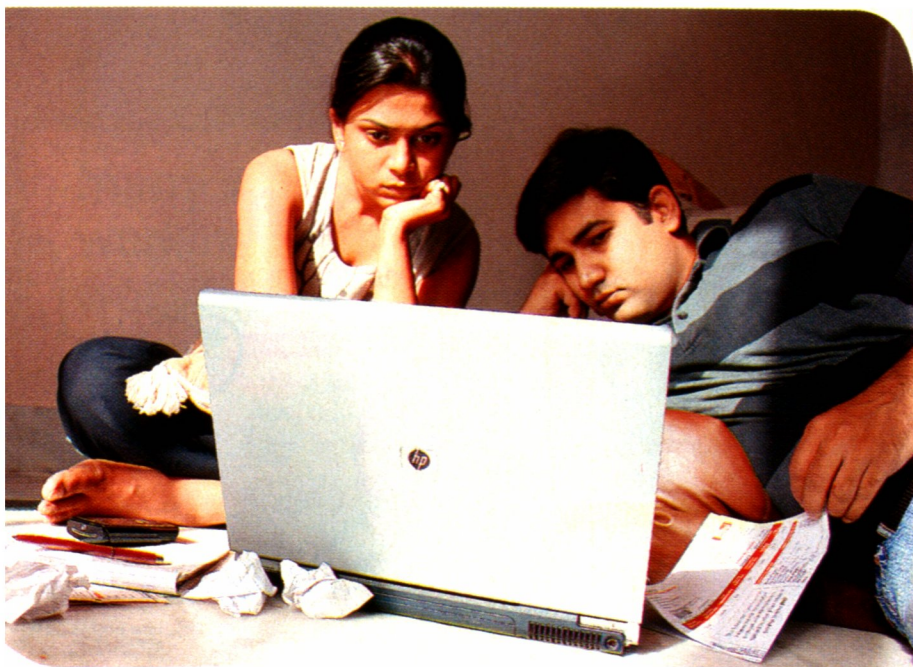
80% feel their parents are compatible as a couple. For **56%**, divorce is better than staying in a bad marriage.

The 2008 survey paints a consistent portrait of urban Indian youth, where everything is as it "should be", points out Visvanathan. In the 2005 survey of attitudes of 2,059 respondents aged 18-35, young people were religious (49 per cent visited places of worship once a week, and 66 per cent were ready to fast for religious reasons), pro-joint family (70 per cent preferred joint families while only 28 per cent preferred nuclear family units) as well as sexually conservative (75 per cent were averse to the idea of live-ins). The next year, the INDIA TODAY-AC Nielsen-ORG-MARG survey of 2,895 18-35-year-olds checked out the differences between youth from small towns and metros. There weren't too many. Over 80 per cent wanted to work and study in India and ultimately stay in the country, with government being the first choice of service. A majority said they would like to live in a joint family (68 per cent). While 73 per cent believed in arranged marriages, only 24 per cent would opt for love marriages. Last year's survey of 2,846 18-30-year-olds portrayed young people as home birds, hopeful of romance and attached to their mobile phones.

THE CO-ED SOCIETY

Sex may not be high on the agenda for the urban youth, but having a girlfriend or boyfriend certainly is, in what is increasingly becoming a mixed society. Over 40 per cent have a boyfriend or girlfriend, and 47 per cent have even introduced them to their parents. Even so, barely one per cent admit they meet friends of the opposite sex in their homes. This, as sociologist Anuja Agrawal says, reveals some contradictions in the respondents' claims. Such relations, while prevalent, do not have a high degree of familial acceptability. Indeed, there is also a distinct lack of sanctioned social space for such relationships to progress. While 27 per cent have to meet them in parks and gardens, 26 per

How do the youth spend their income or pocket money?



Saving/investment	19.0
Household expenses/food	16.3
Eating out/entertainment	13.9
Clothes/accessories	13.0
Mobile/phone/Internet	9.9
Personal care	9.4
Commuting	8.3
Education	6.6
EMIs	1.9
Miscellaneous	1.6

ROHIT GUPTA

Figures don't add up to 100